

To Whom in May Concern:

It is with great enthusiasm that I write this letter of support on behalf of Lea Merritt. Lea recently completed a seminar course under my instruction. The course focused on U.S. history and the role infectious and chronic diseases played in shaping culture and social narratives. Despite Lea's background not being grounded in the academic exploration of U.S. history or public health, she excelled in the course. More to the point, Lea established a high standard for engagement and thoughtful discussion that undoubtedly influenced her classmates and encouraged them to be better prepared and capable of rich and meaningful class participation.

Throughout the semester Lea demonstrated a keen ability to organize large data in a manner that allowed for critical analysis. Lea's analytical skills allowed her to make connections between both the domestic and global factors influencing the socio-cultural and health environments. This skillset, and her general awareness of others and humanity, also gave her powerful perspective when articulating diverse beliefs regarding vaccination, vaccine preventable diseases, and individual versus community responsibility. In fact, Lea's written reflection on the re-emergence of measles in the U.S. is one of the best student products I have received from an undergraduate student, particularly a non-public health student.

When Lea contacted me and asked for a letter of support, I was honored and deeply grateful for the opportunity to endorse her and her talents. Lea's engagement in class elevated the level of discourse and greatly enhanced the learning environment for students as well as myself. For that reason, I have no reservations endorsing Lea in her academic and professional pursuits. If I can be of further assistance, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Alex F. Howard".

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